Annie Finnerty

Product-Minded Software Engineer & Technical Communicator · Remote/U.S. Based

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Professional Summary

Product-minded full-stack software engineer and technical communicator with 5 years building SaaS products for nonprofit and food access organizations. I turn complex needs into accessible products—from discovery to shipped software.

Core Strengths

- **Product Engineering:** React, TypeScript, Next.js, Dot Net/ASP, Webforms, design systems, accessibility, responsive design, UX copy, customer-facing workflows
- **Backend & Cloud:** API design, integrations, authentication, reporting, AWS, Azure, SQL Server, schema design, query optimization, Python
- **Product & UX Collaboration:** discovery calls, stakeholder interviews, usability testing, demos, feedback sessions, requirement elicitation, and scope definition
- **AI & Prototyping:** Azure, OpenAI, retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), AI prototyping and UX, AI-assisted resource discovery
- **Technical Communication:** API documentation, user guides, implementation guides, internal docs, marketing materials, release notes, help content, UX content
- **Tools:** GitHub, Azure DevOps, Figma, LucidChart, Jira, Confluence, Postman, Storybook, Google Analytics, Swagger, Swashbuckle, ReadMe.io

Professional Experience

Upstream Impact (Webit Services) — Software Developer I/II 2021 – 2026 · Naperville, IL

- Build and evolve SaaS products for nonprofit clients across the frontend, backend, microservices, integrations, reporting, documentation, and customer experience.
- Architect and maintain an online shopping site and separate administrative application supporting food pantries and their clients using Next.js, React, MobX, TypeScript, .NET, Azure Functions, and SQL Server.
- Partner with end users, administrators, internal and external stakeholders, and leadership throughout discovery, design, implementation, rollout, and iteration.
- Influence product design decisions across workflows, including information architecture, feature scope, and UX copy.
- Own client experience including extensive product documentation across user guides, help materials, API documentation, and internal knowledge resources.

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- Translate complex customer needs into shipped features, balancing usability, operational constraints, implementation effort, and long-term maintainability.

Selected Product Contributions

- **Online food pantry shopping platform:** Primary contributor to SaaS product supporting online ordering, inventory management, and client administration for over twenty large food pantries and ~80,000 of their end users.
- **Scientific research study support:** Collaborated with researchers and pantry staff to design software support for a nutrition-focused scientific study at a major university. Independently implemented intervention workflows and metric-tracking capabilities with attention to user experience and data integrity.
- **AI product experimentation:** Built and shipped an LLM-enabled food pantry product matching and sorting capability using Azure OpenAI, reducing hundreds of hours of admin time on manual configuration across all pantries.
- **SaaS onboarding redesign:** Partnered with leadership while personally owning major workflow and implementation details.

Amazon Web Services — Premium Support Engineer 2020 · Portland, Oregon

- Supported AWS customers with cloud architecture, implementation, troubleshooting, and operational issues in a premium support environment.
- Built complex prototypes in serverless and application-integration services, including AWS Lambda and API Gateway, to diagnose service behavior.
- Communicated complex cloud concepts clearly to technical customers, translating symptoms, logs, configurations, and architectural context into next steps.

Freelance Web Developer & Writer — Earlier Experience

- Designed and built small business websites, including restaurant and local business sites, using JavaScript, React, and modern web fundamentals.
- Created and edited website content and general business copy for freelance clients.

Education & Credentials

- **BA, English and Anthropology** — The George Washington University
- **Software Engineering Bootcamp** — General Assembly
- **Professional Technical Writer Certificate** — University of Washington
- **Mastering Design Thinking Certificate** — MIT
- **UX/UI Design for AI Certificate** — Stanford University